

Block 4 — Assessment of Personality (Self-Report · Projective · Behavioural)

History of Assessment

Year	Event
~1000 BC	Chinese civil service tests
190 AD	Galen : 4 temperaments
1879	Wundt : first psych lab (Leipzig)
1890	James Cattell : mental test
1905	Binet-Simon : first mental dev scale
1914	Army Alpha/Beta
1916	Terman : IQ; Stanford-Binet
1918	Woodworth : first personality inventory (Personal Data Sheet, 116 items)
1920s	German Assessment Center (military officer selection)
1942	OSS (Office of Strategic Services)
1943	MMPI (Hathaway & McKinley)

Technical Criteria

4 criteria: (1) **Standardisation** — uniform procedures. (2) **Norms** — raw→percentile; representative group. (3) **Reliability** — consistency (test-retest >+.70; split-half; parallel forms; inter-scorer). (4) **Validity** — measures what intended (content; criterion-related: predictive, concurrent, construct; convergent vs divergent [Campbell & Fiske, 1959]; Cronbach & Meehl, 1955).

Self-Report Inventories

Standardised response alternatives (True/False). 5 types: social traits, adjustment, pathological, screening, attitudes/interests/values.

Strengths: objectivity, easy administration, greater reliability, multi-dimensional.

Weaknesses: deliberate deception, social desirability (Marlowe-Crowne, 1964), response set.

Methods to overcome: Rapport, Forced-choice, Concealing purpose, Verification/correction keys. Acquiescence response set.

Firsts: Galton (1880); Woodworth (1918).

16 PF (Cattell, 1995)

Factor analysis → 16 source traits (trait dimensions/continuums). Scores plotted as personality profile. Counseling/employment use.

MMPI-2 (Hathaway & McKinley, 1943)

567 statements (True/False/Cannot Say). **10 clinical scales** + **8 validity scales**. From mild (shyness) to serious (schizophrenia, depression). Items repeated in different form to detect faking. Most common personality inventory.

MBTI (Assessment)

4 dimensions: S/I, T/F, I/E, P/J. 16 types (ISTJ, ISTP, ISFP, ISFJ, etc.). Career assessment. Commercially available.

NEO-PI-R (Costa & McCrae, 1992)

Five-Factor Model. 5 dimensions × 6 facets × 8 items = **240 items**. OCEAN. Most widely used. NEO-FFI = 60-item truncated.

Projective Techniques

Frank (1939) coined "projective technique." Ambiguous stimuli; reveal unconscious. No correct/incorrect answer.

Frank's 5 categories: Constructive, Constitutive, Cathartic, Interpretative, Refractive.

Lindsay (1959): Association, Construction, Completion, Expressive, Choice/Ordering.

Strengths: indirect method; circumvent defenses.

Weaknesses: poorly standardised; low reliability; subjective interpretation; little validity evidence. Rorschach ranked 2nd, TAT 4th in usage.

Rorschach Inkblot (1921)

10 inkblots (5 black, 5 coloured). 3 stages: Performance Proper, Inquiry, Scoring. Location (W/D/Dd), Determinants (F/C/S/M), Content (H/A/Hd/Ad). Response productivity ratio (R): 15–30. Exner Comprehensive System (1969). Holtzman HIT (1961): 2 parallel forms, 45 cards, 22 variables.

TAT (Morgan & Murray, 1935)

20 B&W pictures. Client tells story (present, cause, past, future). "Hero" = identified character. Murray's needs (achievement, affiliation, aggression) + press (environmental forces). Construction technique.

Behavioural Assessment

Direct observation ("sine qua non"). Naturalistic observation (observer bias; Kazdin, 1982). Situational tests (OSS first; leadership, dominance). CEI (Hartshorne, May & Shuttleworth, 1930): altruism, honesty, self-control. Duplicating technique (cheating detection). Limitations: time-consuming, observer bias, "what to observe," visible vs invisible observer.